Engineering & Built Environment Committee (EBE REC)
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https://ebe.uct.ac.za/research/ethics-research

2026/10/06

EBE REC REF : EBE/03373/2026
Jonathan Tirkaso
TRKJON002@myuct.ac.za

Dear Jonathan Tirkaso, (Principal Investigator)

STUDY TITLE: Small-scale solar car for renewable energy demonstration

We appreciate the submission of your study to the UCT Engineering & Built Environment Committee (EBE REC) for review and approval. We are pleased to announce that the EBE REC has formally **Approved** the aforementioned study, with the following comments:

The digital questionnaire should include a clear consent confirmation at the beginning. Participants should be required to indicate whether the necessary consent has been provided before proceeding with the questionnaire. This will provide an additional safeguard and create a clear record that participation is based on informed consent.
Particular attention should be given to privacy and confidentiality, as the participants are school learners. The collection, storage and reporting of data therefore need to be managed carefully to ensure that learners' identities are protected throughout the research process.
The use of photographs, if needed, requires specific consideration. Parents or guardians should be clearly informed about whether photographs will be taken, how they may be used, and whether they could appear in research outputs, presentations, reports, promotional materials or future dissemination activities. Separate and explicit consent should be obtained for photography, as some parents or guardians may consent to participation in the study but may not consent to their child being photographed or having their image used beyond the immediate research activity. Where appropriate, learners' assent should also be obtained.
A data management plan is required and it should specify how the data will be stored, who will have access to it, how long it will be retained, and how it will eventually be disposed of. Electronic data should be stored securely using password-protected and appropriately access-controlled systems.
It is also important to state clearly that identifiable or sensitive learner data will not be uploaded to, processed through, or used to train public or third-party generative AI systems. Any use of AI tools in the research process should therefore be carefully managed to ensure that participant confidentiality and data protection are maintained.

Approval is only granted for one year and expires on **2026/12/31.**

Applications for renewal must be made prior to the expiration date, per Engineering & Built Environment Committee processes and any research conducted while renewals are being processed must conform to the approved research protocols.

Progress reports and/or close-out reports are required as specified in our Standard Operating Procedures, available on our website: https://ebe.uct.ac.za/research/ethics-research.

Kindly be aware that for all studies approved by the EBE REC, the principal investigator must

acquire suitable institutional authorisation, if required, prior to conducting the research. The procedure for requesting access to UCT staff and students, or their data, is available here: https://uct.ac.za/research-support-hub/integrity/accessing-uct-staff-or-students-research-population.

Additionally, please note that the principal investigator bears the ongoing responsibility for the ethical conduct of study, and that this approval extends only to the named investigators conducting the study. The following people have been approved to participate in this study:

- No additional people conducting this study.

Please quote the EBE REC Reference in all your correspondence.

Yours sincerely

Harro Von Blottnitz

Chairperson
Engineering & Built Environment Committee